

Brand Messaging Hierarchy Template

Positioning to Proof

When messaging lives in people's heads, every channel says something slightly different. This template makes the hierarchy explicit and reusable.

What's inside

- Positioning statement formula
- Three-pillar message architecture
- Proof point requirements
- Audience-specific variations
- Banned words and claims list

Positioning

- 01 For [audience] who [need], we are the [category] that [differentiator]
- 02 One sentence, no adjectives that competitors could also claim
- 03 Must be defensible with evidence
- 04 Reviewed annually, not rewritten quarterly

Message Pillars

- 01 Exactly three — more and nothing is remembered
- 02 Each pillar answers a distinct buyer objection
- 03 Each pillar carries at least two proof points
- 04 Pillars stay stable while campaigns rotate

Proof

- 01 Every claim maps to data, a case study, or a named customer
- 02 Remove any claim you cannot evidence on request
- 03 Prefer specific numbers over superlatives
- 04 Update proof as new results land

Language Discipline

- 01 List the words the brand always uses
- 02 List the words it never uses, with reasons
- 03 Define how to describe competitors, if at all
- 04 Specify tone shifts by channel

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